

# Morgan Slate

## ACT I / Before the murder

### Your history with Sterling

Sterling discovered that you write an anonymous satirical newsletter skewering museum patrons and planned to unmask you during his speech.

### What you are hiding

Several jokes in the newsletter came from private conversations, and you regret at least one of them. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

### Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

### What you know about other guests

- Sterling has been trying to block Theo from joining the museum board.
- Nadia is working on something far more serious than a gala review and Sterling knows it.

*Notes / Who will you speak to first?*

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## **ACT II / After Sterling dies**

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

### **IF INNOCENT**

Nadia was arguing with you in the dining room throughout the critical minutes.

### **IF MURDERER**

You entered at 6:44 to beg him not to expose you, poisoned the cordial, and left a torn draft joke in the bin.

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## **ACT III / Evidence update**

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

## **FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called**

### **IF INNOCENT**

I write the anonymous newsletter half this room pretends not to read. Some of its best lines came from private conversations, and Sterling planned to unmask me publicly. Nadia and I were busy arguing in the dining room while the cordial was poisoned. My weapon is usually a paragraph.

### **IF MURDERER**

Sterling was going to put my name behind every anonymous line and let the room do the rest. I went in to bargain, poisoned his cordial when he refused, and tore up the draft I had brought with me. Critics are supposed to survive being disliked. I chose not to test that principle.

*Investigation notes*

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